

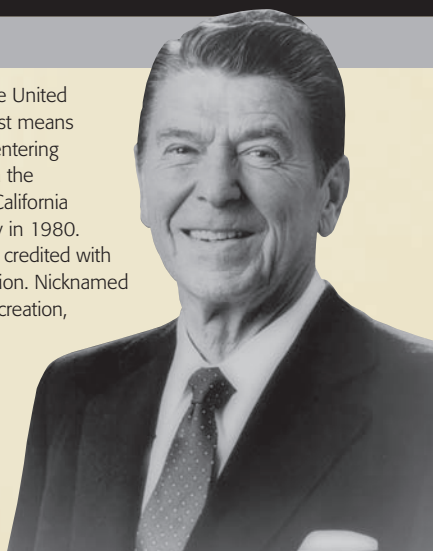
US PRESIDENT (1911–2004)

RONALD REAGAN

Ronald Reagan was the 40th President of the United States (1981–89). Born to a family of modest means in Illinois, he was a Hollywood actor before entering politics. In 1962 he switched allegiance from the Democrats to the Republicans, winning the California governorship in 1966 and the US presidency in 1980.

A genial and relaxed personality, Reagan is credited with revitalizing America's economy after a recession. Nicknamed "Reaganomics," his policies consisted of job creation, tax cuts, deregulation, but soaring budget deficits. Reagan was reelected by a landslide in 1984, after record-breaking economic growth.

Though virulently anticommunist, his good relationship with Soviet premier Mikhail Gorbachev helped bring a peaceful end to the Cold War.



1980 Ronald Reagan wins election for the Republicans.

1981 John Hinckley, Jr., shoots and wounds Ronald Reagan outside a Washington, DC, hotel.

1981 Columbia, the world's first reusable space shuttle, makes its maiden flight.

1981 Sandra Day O'Connor, a Republican, becomes the first female US Supreme Court Justice.

1983 Military invasion of Grenada to overthrow left-wing government.

1984 Reagan wins a landslide victory against the Democrat Walter Mondale.

1985 Relations with the USSR improve as President Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev hold the first of three summits.

1986 Iran-Contra affair is revealed: the US government has illegally supplied arms to Iran and used the profits to fund the Contra rebels fighting the elected left-wing government of Nicaragua.



Oprah Winfrey

One of the most influential (and wealthiest) media figures in the world, Winfrey overcame poverty to create a media empire including a talk show, a magazine, and stage and screen productions.

1987 Intermediate-Range Nuclear Forces Treaty signed by US and USSR: all intermediate-range missiles are destroyed, the first time a complete class of missiles has been destroyed.

1987 The Space Shuttle Challenger explodes shortly after launch on January 28, killing all seven astronauts aboard. The crew included New Hampshire schoolteacher Christa McAuliffe.

1987 US warplanes bomb Tripoli, Libya, after a bomb believed to have been planted by Libyan agents kills three people, including two US servicemen, in a Berlin nightclub.

1987 On "Black Monday," October 19, stocks fall steeply, leading to Wall Street's biggest one-day loss in decades.

1988 In the Persian Gulf, a missile from the US warship *Vincennes* is mistakenly launched at an Iranian civil airliner. All 290 people aboard are killed.

1988 Space Shuttle flights, halted since the *Challenger* disaster, resume with the launch of the shuttle *Discovery*.

1989 US overthrows General Noriega of Panama and arrests him on drug charges.

1989 The oil tanker Exxon Valdez runs aground in Prince William Sound, Alaska, spilling more than 1 million barrels of oil in what is perhaps the worst environmental disaster in US history.

1991 US-led Gulf War liberates Kuwait from Iraqi occupation. The conflict begins in August 1990 when Iraqi forces invade the neighboring country, which Iraqi dictator Saddam Hussein claims is Iraq's "19th Province." The first phase of the war, Operation Desert Shield, is the buildup of US and other coalition forces (including those from several Arab nations) in Saudi Arabia. The second phase, Operation Desert Storm, begins with a massive air offensive, followed by a land campaign that lasts three days before the Iraqis retreat from Kuwait. Saddam Hussein remains in power, however.

1992 Black youths riot in Los Angeles and other cities after an all-white jury acquits four white Los Angeles police officers of beating a black motorist, Rodney King, despite video evidence. In three days of violence in Los Angeles, more than 50 people are killed and the city sustains about \$1 billion in property damage.

1992 Democratic candidate Bill Clinton defeats George Bush in his bid for reelection. Al Gore becomes vice president. (Running as an Independent, billionaire businessman H. Ross Perot receives almost 19 percent of the popular vote.) Bush's popularity had soared following the successful conclusion of the Gulf War, but an economic recession (and Bush's violation of his pledge not to raise taxes) hampered him in the months prior to the election.

1993 Martin Luther King, Jr.'s birthday becomes a public holiday in all 50 states.

1994 Health care reform legislation is defeated in Congress.

1994 North American Free Trade Agreement with Canada and Mexico goes into effect.

1994 Special counsel investigation of Whitewater affair begins over the Clintons' financial dealings in Arkansas.

In midterm elections, the Republicans gain majorities in both houses of Congress. Newt Gingrich, architect of the victories with his "Contract with America," becomes Speaker of the House.

1995 Oklahoma City bombing by right-wing activist Timothy McVeigh; over 160 die when a truck bomb is detonated outside the city's federal office building.

1996 Clinton and Gore reelected.

1997 Madeleine Albright becomes the first woman to head the State Department.

1998 Scandal over Clinton's affair with a White House intern leads to impeachment proceedings for suspected perjury and abuse of power.

1998 US embassies in Kenya and Tanzania are bombed by Islamic militants; the US launches air strikes on Sudan and Afghanistan in revenge.

1999 Clinton is acquitted in his impeachment trial as the Senate finds him not guilty of perjury by 55 votes to 45.

1999 In the Kosovo War, warplanes and missiles from US and other NATO forces attack Yugoslavia.

1999 Columbine High School in Colorado is the scene of a horrific school shooting;

"I can hear you. The rest of the world hears you. And the people who **knocked these buildings down will hear all of us soon."**

PRESIDENT GEORGE W. BUSH TO RESCUE WORKERS AT GROUND ZERO, SEPTEMBER 14, 2001



Ceremony at Ground Zero

On September 11, 2002, relatives of those who died in the attack on the World Trade Center gathered to mark the first anniversary of 9/11. Among those killed on 9/11 were 343 New York City firefighters and 50 New York City and Port Authority police officers.